

QIFAN HAN

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Personal Website

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor of Marketing <i>School of Management and Economics, Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen</i>	07/2026 - Present
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EDUCATION

Boston University <i>Ph.D. in Economics</i>	09/2019 - 05/2026
London School of Economics <i>M.Sc. Econometrics and Mathematical Economics</i>	09/2018 - 08/2019
Columbia University <i>M.A. in Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences</i>	09/2016 - 01/2018
Fudan University <i>LL.B. in International Politics</i>	09/2012 - 08/2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Topics: Digital Marketing, Digital Platform, Applied Econometrics, Generative AI
Methods: Causal Inference, AI, Partial Identification, Structural Modeling, Analytical Modeling

WORKING PAPERS

“The Impact of Banning Online Gambling Livestreams: Evidence from Twitch.tv”
w/ Jasmine Yang and Andrey Simonov R&R, Marketing Science

“Collaboration Among Content Creators”
w/ Jasmine Yang and Kinshuk Jerath

“Partial Identification Under Multiple Nest Structures”

“Impulse Response Inferences With Existence of Repeated Roots”

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Measuring Causal Effects under Opaque Targeting”

“Optimal Achievement System Design on Video Game Platforms”

RESEARCH ABSTRACTS

“The Impact of Banning Online Gambling Livestreams: Evidence from Twitch.tv”
with Jasmine Yang and Andrey Simonov
R&R, Marketing Science

Abstract: How effective is platform self-regulation at eliminating harmful content? We examine Twitch’s ban on unlicensed online gambling livestreams implemented in October 2022. Using a novel panel dataset covering the top 6,000 Twitch streamers, we identify banned content and affected streamers by leveraging video analysis of historical clips, high-frequency stream titles, and in-stream chats. On the supply side, the policy led to a 63.2% reduction in weekly gambling streams and a 44.3% decrease in overall streams among streamers whose content was banned. Streamers whose gambling content was not banned also reduced their gambling and overall content, indicating spillover effects from the policy. This reaction was more pronounced among

popular streamers and those with greater reputation concerns. On the demand side, while the policy reduced total viewership, low-tier subscriptions, and engagement, revenue from high-tier subscriptions (reflecting more loyal viewers) remained unaffected. The policy also reduced the gambling viewership for viewers classified as minors, although the magnitude was slightly smaller than for other viewers. Our findings highlight both the potential and limitations of platform self-regulation: although targeted bans can substantially reduce targeted content and its engagement, complementary actions may be necessary to mitigate unintended side effects and ensure effective protection for specific user groups.

“Collaboration Among Content Creators”

with Jasmine Yang and Kinshuk Jerath

Working paper

Abstract: We study content collaboration in the creator economy, in which competing creators mutually agree to collaborate on joint content and negotiate on content production and revenue sharing. Using a game theory model with creators competing for consumers on a Hotelling line, we show that collaboration allows creators to use the jointly-produced content to moderate competition, while using their individual content to expand into new audiences. This increases content diversity but also leads to increased monetizability of content. In general, collaboration among creators has an effect of increasing the profits of creators while reducing consumer surplus. When creators create content with heterogeneous entertainment values, the creator producing content of lower entertainment value has an incentive to free ride on the collaborative content. This free riding may increase surplus for consumers (who without collaboration would watch content of low entertainment value), thereby improving creators' profits as well as consumer surplus. Our results provide guidance to content creators, to platforms designing tools to facilitate collaborations, and to policy makers.

“Impulse Response Inferences With Existence of Repeated Roots”

Working paper

Abstract: Vector Autoregression (VAR) and Local Projection (LP) are two popular methods of estimating the impulse response functions (IRFs) and conducting inferences in macroeconomic studies. However, it remains unclear which one should be a better choice in empirical practices. This paper extends existing works on the comparison between Vector Autoregression and Local Projection methods, by considering inferences when the data generating processes involve repeated roots. I show that the autoregressive estimation of impulse response functions will converge to a special type of real-valued random variable, resulting in conservativeness of the widely-used bootstrap Efron confidence interval, even when the roots are away from the unit circle. This property of conservativeness becomes even more severe in the following cases: 1) when the time series is highly persistent; and 2) when the researcher is interested in impulse response functions at intermediate or long horizons. The theoretical results are supported by Monte Carlo simulations with different values of roots in a variety of model specifications, including AR(2), AR(3) and VAR(1).

“Partial Identification Under Multiple Nest Structures”

Working in progress; draft in preparation

Abstract: Nested logit model is one of the most widely applied tools in discrete choice analysis, due to its ability to capture rich substitution patterns in market data. However, the researcher needs to define a nest structure ex ante, as the chosen nest is usually based on prior knowledge of the market and will be applied to all individuals. This paper discusses the identification of individual preferences, while relaxing this unique nest structure assumption and allowing for heterogeneity in individuals' recognition of the nest structures in the same market. I characterize the sharp identification region of parameters in the nested logit model, based on the coexistence of a given set of nest structures. I show in a series of Monte Carlo simulations that misspecification of the nest structure may result in the identification region not covering the true parameter, whereas the identification region solves the misspecification problem and partially identifies the parameters by allowing for multiple nest structures.

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

ISMS Marketing Science	06/2025
New Data for Consumer Insights Conference	05/2025
Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics	12/2024
Interactive Marketing Research Conference	05/2024
Boston University Econometrics Seminar	05/2024
Boston University Applied Microeconomics Workshop	03/2024
China India Insights Conference	09/2023
Boston University Econometrics Seminar	10/2021, 04/2023, 10/2024

TEACHING

Marketing Research in the Digital Age: M.Sc. Marketing <i>Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen</i>	Fall 2025
Digital and Social Media Marketing Strategy: Undergraduate <i>M.Sc. Econometrics and Mathematical Economics</i>	Fall 2025

SKILLS

Programming: MATLAB, R, Python, Stata, SQL
Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native), Japanese (intermediate)
Hobbies: tennis, video games